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Inventor(s)

Karim; M Ziaul et al.

APPARATUS AND METHOD FOR COATING REMOVAL

Abstract

An apparatus for removing a coating from a substrate comprises a nozzle with an inner conduit having an orifice and an outer conduit coaxially arranged about the inner conduit and defining an annular opening between the inner and outer conduits. The nozzle is configured to direct a liquid stream through the orifice toward the coated surface and direct a gas flow through the annular opening such that the gas flow surrounds the liquid stream as the liquid stream moves towards the coated surface.

Inventors: Karim; M Ziaul (San Jose, CA), Cekic; Dragan (Princeton, NJ)

Applicant: Yield Engineering Systems, Inc. (Fremont, CA)

Family ID: 90365792

Assignee: Yield Engineering Systems, Inc. (Fremont, CA)

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a divisional of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/124,871, filed Mar. 22, 2023, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to an apparatus and a method for the removal of one or more coatings from a panel.

BACKGROUND

[0003] The fabrication process of semiconductor and photonic devices is composed of many sequential steps to produce complete electrical and/or photonic circuits on a wafer or a panel (collectively referred to herein as a substrate) of a suitable material (e.g., semiconductor wafers, glass panels, etc.). Defects of any source introduced during the fabrication process reduces yield of the resulting devices. A common source of defects are the residues of coatings (e.g., deposited films, etc.) on the edge(s) of a substrate that the devices are formed on. These coating residues on the edge may be the result of incomplete removal of a coating used in the fabrication process from the edge. The substrate edge may be part of (or form), for example, the substrate bevel, substrate edge exclusion zone, handling area, etc. For example, portions of the residual coatings (e.g., metal films such as Ti, Cu, Pd, Ni, etc.) retained on the substrate may peel or delaminate during subsequent processing (e.g., deposition, heating, etc.) of the substrate and cause defects in the resulting device. Thus, processes to satisfactorily remove the coatings from the edge(s) of a substrate used in semiconductor fabrication are important.

[0004] Currently there are limited ways to remove coatings from a substrate edge. One current method uses plasma or laser ablation where a suitable laser beam (e.g., a YAG laser) is focused on the coated substrate to ablate the coating. In addition to requiring multiple passes for satisfactory coating removal, such a removal method may also result in redeposition of debris on coated surfaces (requiring subsequent cleaning steps) and result in defects. Furthermore, laser and plasma ablation tools are expensive and may require good ventilation and other protection systems for safe use. Moreover, with substrates becoming thinner (e.g., 200-250 micron), traditional laser coating removal methods risk breaking fragile panels. Additionally, some coatings (such as, for example, copper, titanium, etc.) are difficult to remove using a laser because of the large amount of energy needed for their removal.

[0005] The apparatus and methods of the current disclosure may alleviate at least some of the above-described deficiencies. However, the scope of the current disclosure is defined by the claims and not by its ability to solve any problem.

SUMMARY

[0006] Embodiments of an apparatus for coating removal and method of coating removal are disclosed.

[0007] In one embodiment, an apparatus to remove at least a portion of a coating from a coated surface of a substrate comprises at least one nozzle extending from a proximal end to a distal end, wherein at least a distal end portion of the at least one nozzle extends along a longitudinal axis inclined at an angle θ with the coated surface. The at least one nozzle may include an inner conduit having an orifice at the distal end and an outer conduit coaxially arranged about the inner conduit and defining an annular opening between the inner and outer conduits. The inner conduit may be configured to direct a liquid stream through the orifice to impinge on the coated surface and the

outer conduit may be configured to direct a gas flow through the annular opening to surround the liquid stream from the orifice. The apparatus may also include an outlet port configured to direct liquid from the liquid stream away from the substrate after the liquid stream impinges the coated surface.

[0008] Various embodiments of the disclosed apparatus may additionally or alternatively include one of more of the following features: further include a heater configured to heat the liquid stream exiting the orifice; the apparatus may be configured to vary the angle θ between about 0-180°; the apparatus may be configured to vary a pressure of the liquid stream exiting through the orifice; the apparatus may be configured to vary a pressure of the gas exiting through the annular opening; the apparatus may be configured to translate the nozzle to trace a path using the liquid stream on the coated surface; the liquid stream may include a chemical composition that includes one or more of H.sub.2O.sub.2, H.sub.2SO.sub.4, SPS (sodium persulfate), and TechniEtch™ TBR19 concentrate (TBR19), and the gas flow may include air.

[0009] In another embodiment, a method of removing a coating from a coated surface of a substrate comprises positioning a nozzle of an apparatus proximate a coated surface of a substrate such that a longitudinal axis of a distal end of the nozzle is inclined at an angle θ with the coated surface. The nozzle may include an inner conduit having an orifice and an outer conduit coaxially arranged about the inner conduit and defining an annular opening between the inner and outer conduits. The method may also include directing a liquid stream through the orifice of the inner conduit toward the coated surface, and directing a gas flow through the annular opening toward the coated surface such that the gas flow surrounds the liquid stream from the orifice. The method may further include impinging the liquid stream on the coated surface to remove at least a portion of a coating of the coated surface.

[0010] Various embodiments of the disclosed method may additionally or alternatively include one of more of the following steps or features: further include directing liquid from the liquid stream away from the substrate after the liquid stream impinges on the coated surface; positioning the nozzle may include adjusting the angle θ ; positioning the nozzle may include adjusting a distance of the distal end of the nozzle from the coated surface; directing the liquid stream may include adjusting a pressure of a liquid directed through the inner conduit; directing the gas flow may include adjusting a pressure of a gas directed through the outer conduit; directing the liquid stream may include directing a liquid chemical composition through the inner conduit, wherein the chemical composition may include one or more of H.sub.2O.sub.2, H.sub.2SO.sub.4, SPS (sodium persulfate), and TechniEtch™ TBR19 concentrate (TBR19); directing the gas flow may include directing air through the outer conduit; further include moving the nozzle to trace a path using the liquid stream on the coated surface; and directing the liquid stream may include heating a liquid in the liquid stream.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein and constitute a part of this disclosure, illustrate exemplary embodiments and, together with the description, are used to explain the disclosed principles. In these drawings, where appropriate, reference numerals that illustrate the same or similar structures, components, materials, and/or elements in different figures are labeled similarly. It is understood that various combinations of the structures, components, and/or elements, other than those specifically shown, are contemplated and are within the scope of the present disclosure.

[0012] For simplicity and clarity of illustration, the figures depict the general structure of the various described embodiments. Details of well-known components or features may be omitted to

avoid obscuring other features, since these omitted features are well-known to those of ordinary skill in the art. Further, features in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. The dimensions of some features may be exaggerated relative to other features to improve understanding of the exemplary embodiments. One skilled in the art would appreciate that the features in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale and, unless indicated otherwise, should not be viewed as representing dimensions or proportional relationships between different features in a figure. Additionally, even if it is not expressly mentioned, aspects described with reference to one embodiment or figure may also be applicable to, and may be used with, other embodiments or figures.

[0013] FIG. 1 is a schematic side view of an exemplary apparatus used to remove coatings from a panel;

[0014] FIG. 2 is a schematic perspective view of an exemplary apparatus used to remove coatings from a panel; and

[0015] FIG. 3 is an illustration of an exemplary nozzle of the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0016] FIG. 4 is an illustration of an exemplary tear drop shaped liquid droplet created by the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0017] FIGS. 5A and 5B are simplified depictions illustrating an exemplary method of coating removal by the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0018] FIG. 6 is schematic illustration showing different exemplary methods of using the apparatus of FIG. 1 to remove a coating;

[0019] FIG. 7 is a flow chart illustrating an exemplary method of using the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0020] FIGS. 8A and 8B illustrates a sharp edge formed after removal of an exemplary coating from an edge of a substrate; and

[0021] FIG. 9 illustrates an exemplary apparatus with a nozzle of FIG. 1.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0022] All relative terms such as “about,” “substantially,” “approximately,” etc., indicate a possible variation of +10% (unless noted otherwise or another degree of variation is specified). For example, a feature disclosed as being about “t” units wide (or length, thickness, depth, etc.) may vary in width from (t-0.1t) to (t+0.1t) units. In some cases, the specification also provides context to some of the relative terms used. For example, a structure (e.g., a coating edge) described as being substantially linear may deviate by $\pm 10\%$ from being linear. As another example, a feature (e.g., a coating edge, etc.) described as having a substantially sharp or substantially step-like configuration or shape (e.g., , ) may deviate by $\pm 10\%$ from being perfectly step-like (e.g., a shape having rounded corners, such as, for example, , , , , etc.) Further, a range described as varying from, or between, 5 to 10 (5-10), includes the endpoints (i.e., 5 and 10).

[0023] Unless otherwise defined, all terms of art, notations, and other scientific terms or terminology used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by persons of ordinary skill in the art to which this disclosure belongs. Some components, structures, and/or processes described or referenced herein are well understood and commonly employed using conventional methodology by those skilled in the art. These components, structures, and processes will not be described in detail. All patents, applications, published applications and other publications referred to herein as being incorporated by reference are incorporated by reference in their entirety. If a definition or description set forth in this disclosure is contrary to, or otherwise inconsistent with, a definition and/or description in these references, the definition and/or description set forth in this disclosure controls over those in references incorporated by reference. None of the references described or referenced herein is admitted as prior art relative to the current disclosure.

[0024] The discussion below describes an exemplary apparatus and method used to remove a coating from an edge (or the edge zone) of a substrate (e.g., wafer, panel, etc.). It should be noted that the specific features of the described apparatus are not limitations. Instead, embodiments of the

described apparatus may be used to remove any coating(s) from any substrate in any suitable application. For example, the disclosed apparatus and method may be used to remove any type of one or more coatings (organic, inorganic, metallic, etc.) from any type of substrate (e.g., panel, wafer, base plate, etc.). In the discussion below, the term “substrate” is used broadly to refer to any component having a relatively flat surface upon which a coating is disposed (conformally, as patches, in regions, etc.). For example, as used herein, a substrate includes a plate, a panel (e.g., a glass panel), a semiconductor wafer (e.g., a silicon wafer), a wafer with multiple IC devices formed thereon, a single IC device, a substrate (e.g., ceramic, organic, metallic, etc.) with one or more coatings formed or disposed thereon, etc. The “coating” on the substrate may be formed of any material (organic, inorganic, metallic, etc.), have any thickness, and may (without limitation) be disposed on the substrate by any known method (e.g., deposited, sprayed, plated, grown on, etc.). [0025] FIGS. **1** and **2** are schematic illustrations of an exemplary apparatus **100** of the current disclosure that may be used to remove a coating **24** from an edge **10** of a substrate **20**. FIG. **1** illustrates a side view and FIG. **2** illustrates a perspective view. In the discussion below, reference will be made to both FIGS. **1** and **2**. A surface of substrate **20** may include one or more coatings deposited (or otherwise formed) thereon. For example, a first coating **22** may be deposited on the top surface of substrate **20** and a second coating **24** may be deposited on top of the first coating **22**. In some embodiments, additional coatings may be deposited on top of the second coating **24**. In general, any number of coatings may be deposited on substrate **20**. In some embodiments, multiple coatings may be deposited one atop another on substrate **20** while in other embodiments substrate **20** may only have a single coating. Substrate **20** may include any type of substrate (e.g., semiconductor wafer, glass panel, etc.) and the first and second coatings **22**, **24** may include any organic, inorganic, or metallic material. A non-limiting list of materials that may be deposited (or otherwise formed in any order) on substrate **20** may include, for example, silicon, silicon dioxide, silicon nitride, silicon carbide, polyamide, dielectric material(s), copper, aluminum, tungsten, tungsten carbide, tungsten nitride, titanium, titanium nitride, tantalum, aluminum, other metals, etc. Apparatus **100** may be used to remove one or more of the coatings **22**, **24** from any region (e.g., one or more of the edges **10**) of substrate **20**. Although not a requirement, in some embodiments, the process of coating removal may include a single one or a combination of, for example, etching and ablation.

[0026] For the sake of brevity, the use of apparatus **100** to remove the top-most coating (e.g., second coating **24**) from an edge **10** of an exemplary substrate **20** in the form of a rectangular glass panel with a first coating **22** made of titanium (Ti) and a second coating **24** made of copper (Cu) will be described below. However, this configuration is only exemplary, and embodiments of the disclosed apparatus **100** may be used to remove any desired coating(s) from any type of substrate.

[0027] Apparatus **100** may be used to direct a stream or a spray of a chemical composition on a desired edge **10** of the substrate **20** through a nozzle **30**. FIG. **3** is a schematic illustration of an exemplary nozzle **30** that may be used with apparatus **100**. As illustrated in FIG. **3**, nozzle **30** includes a pair of co-axially arranged conduits—an inner conduit **32** and outer conduit **34**. The inner and outer conduits **32**, **34** may extend along a longitudinal axis **90** at the distal end of the nozzle **30**. In some embodiments, the nozzle **30** may be a substantially linear component and its inner and outer conduits **32**, **34** may extend linearly along the longitudinal axis **90** from the proximal to the distal end of the nozzle **30**. However, this is not a requirement. In some embodiments, as illustrated in FIG. **2**, the nozzle **30** may be curved and a small section at the distal end, or a tangent at the distal end, may extend along the longitudinal axis **90** such that fluid exits the nozzle **30** along the longitudinal axis **90**. Inner conduit **32** includes a channel **36** configured to direct a liquid (or a chemical composition) therethrough, and an orifice **34** at the distal end that is configured to discharge (or spray a stream of) the liquid on the substrate **20**. An annular channel **46** may be defined between the outer wall of the inner conduit **32** and the inner wall of the outer conduit **42**. The annular channel **46** may be configured to direct a gas stream around the liquid

stream exiting the orifice **34** through an annular opening **44** at the distal end of the outer conduit **42**. The gas stream exiting the annular opening **44** surrounds (e.g., forms a shroud around) the liquid stream from the orifice **34** and assists in focusing the liquid stream on a concentrated area of the substrate **20**.

[0028] In general, any type of a liquid chemical composition may be directed through the inner conduit **32**. Typically, the type of liquid may depend on the application (e.g., the coating to be removed). For example, in some embodiments when a copper coating is to be removed from substrate **20**, the chemical composition used may be based on one or more (e.g., a combination) of: H.sub.2O.sub.2/H.sub.2SO.sub.4; SPS/H.sub.2SO.sub.4; CuCl.sub.2; a combination of different proportion of any of the above chemistries. In some embodiments, when a titanium coating is to be removed, the chemical composition directed through the inner conduit **32** may be based on one or more of: H.sub.2O.sub.2/H.sub.2SO.sub.4; TechniEtch™ TBR19 concentrate (TBR 19)/H.sub.2O.sub.2; a combination of different proportion of any of the above chemistries. In some embodiments, the chemical composition may provide high selectivity to different coatings and other materials that may be present in the substrate **20** (e.g., Si, EMC, Polyimide, SiO.sub.2, etc.). For example, in an embodiment where apparatus **100** is used to remove copper film deposited over, for example, titanium film on a processed semiconductor substrate **20** (that includes materials such as polyamide, SiO.sub.2, etc.), the applied chemical composition may selectively remove copper without affecting (or with minimal effect on) the other materials.

[0029] It should be emphasized that the compositions described above are only exemplary and any liquid may be directed to the substrate **20** through the inner conduit **32**. Similarly, any type of a gas (e.g., air, nitrogen, an inert gas, etc.) may be directed to the substrate **20** through the outer conduit **42**. In some embodiments, the gas directed through the outer conduit **42** may be air irrespective of the type of liquid directed through the inner conduit **32**. In some embodiments, the type of gas may depend on the type of liquid used. The coating (e.g., second coating **24**) may be removed by the liquid chemical composition by, for example, ablation, etching, or a combination of etching and ablation. In some embodiments, the liquid chemical composition discharged through the nozzle **30** may be heated. It is also contemplated that, in some embodiments, the gas discharged through the nozzle **30** may also be heated. The apparatus **100** may include one or more heaters configured to heat the liquid and/or gas directed to the substrate **20** through the nozzle **30**. In some embodiments, these heaters may be coupled to the nozzle **30**. In some cases, heating the liquid chemical composition (and/or the gas) may assist in coating removal.

[0030] With reference to FIGS. **1** and **2**, when a liquid stream **50** is directed at the substrate **20** through nozzle **30**, the gas flow **60** around the liquid stream **50** streamlines and concentrates the flow of the liquid stream **50** and the shape of the liquid droplets **70** impinging on the second coating **24**. The liquid droplets **70** impinging on the substrate **20** assists in removing the second coating **24** from the substrate surface. The distance (d) of the nozzle **30** from the substrate surface, the pressure (P.sub.l) of the liquid directed through the inner conduit **32**, the pressure (P.sub.g) of the gas directed through the outer conduit **42**, and the angle (θ) of inclination of the longitudinal axis **90** of nozzle **30** may be adjusted such that the liquid droplets **70** that impinge on the substrate surface have a tear-drop shape. As illustrated in FIG. **4**, a tear-drop shaped liquid droplet **70** may be curved (curved end **72**) at one end and substantially pointed at the opposite end. The relatively large radius of the curved end **72** assists in removing the second coating **24** while forming a sharp edge **74**.

[0031] It should be noted that although FIGS. **1-3** illustrate the inner conduit **32** as extending further than the outer conduit **42** such that the orifice **34** extends further along the longitudinal axis **90** than the annular opening **44**, this is only exemplary and not a requirement. In some embodiments, the orifice **34** and the annular opening **44** may be disposed at substantially the same location along the longitudinal axis **90**. It should also be noted that, although these figures illustrate the inner and outer conduits **32**, **42** as being centered about the longitudinal axis **90** with a constant

dimension (e.g., width) annular channel **46** extending along the length of the nozzle **30**, this is only exemplary. In some embodiments, the width of the annular channel **46** may vary along the length of the nozzle **30**. Inner and outer conduits **32**, **34** may be made of any material (e.g., metal, glass, plastic, etc.) and may have any size and shape. In some embodiments, the material used to form the inner and outer conduits **32**, **34** may depend on the fluids (e.g., chemical composition and gas) directed through these conduits, and the size and shape of these conduits may depend on the size of the region from which a coating is to be removed.

[0032] With reference to FIG. 1, in some embodiments, apparatus **100** or nozzle **30** may be configured such that the angle (θ) of inclination of the nozzle **30** may be varied. In general, the angle (θ) may be varied between about 0-180°. In general, the angle (θ) may be varied between about 10-180°, about 20-90° or about 30-60°. Apparatus **100** or nozzle **30** may also be configured to enable nozzle **30** to translate along the substrate surface. Additionally, apparatus **100** or nozzle **30** may also be configured to vary distance (d) and pressures P.sub.l and/or P.sub.g. In some embodiments, only one of P.sub.l and P.sub.g may be varied. It is also contemplated that, in some embodiments, both P.sub.l and P.sub.g may have the same value. Although not a requirement, in some embodiments, distance (d) may be varied between about 1-50 mm or between about 10-20 mm, and one of both of P.sub.l and P.sub.g may be varied between 10-60 psi or between about 15-25 psi. The values of these parameters (e.g., θ , d, P.sub.l, P.sub.g) used may depend upon the application (type and size of substrate, type and thickness of films, etc.). In general, one or more of these parameters may be varied to produce liquid droplets of a desired shape that removes a coating in an efficient manner. FIGS. 8A and 8B show an exemplary sharp edge **74** formed upon the removal of a copper coating (e.g., second coating **24**) from an edge of a panel coated with copper over titanium (e.g., first coating **22**) using apparatus **100**. FIG. 8B is an enlarged view of a portion of the edge circled in FIG. 8A. As illustrated in FIG. 8B, adjusting one or more of the parameters (e.g., θ , d, P.sub.l, P.sub.g) completely removes the copper coating from the edge and produces a sharp edge **74**.

[0033] FIGS. 5A and 5B schematically illustrate the effect of providing gas flow **60** around the liquid stream **50** from nozzle **30**. As illustrated in FIG. 5A, without the gas flow **60**, the liquid stream **50** exiting the orifice **34** will impact larger area (A.sub.1) on the surface of the coated substrate **20**. As illustrated in FIG. 5B, the gas flow **60** exiting the nozzle **30** through the annular opening **44** surrounds the liquid stream **50** and causes the liquid stream **50** to impact a smaller and more well defined area (A.sub.2) of the coated substrate **20**. Moreover, the gas flow **60** results in liquid droplets of a desirable shape (e.g., a tear-drop shaped, etc.) to remove coatings with a sharp edge. In some embodiments, the gas flow **60** around the liquid stream **50** extends all the way from the distal end of the nozzle **30** to the substrate surface. However, this is not a requirement. In some embodiments, the selected parameters may cause the surrounding gas flow **60** to terminate before the substrate surface.

[0034] When apparatus **100** is used to remove a coating (e.g., second coating **24**) on substrate **20**, as represented by arrow A in FIG. 2, the nozzle **30** may be translated (or moved) to trace a path using the liquid stream **50** on the substrate surface. The second coating **24** may be removed along this path. The relatively large radius of the curved end **72** of the tear-drop shaped liquid droplets **70** (see FIG. 4) assists in forming a sharp edge **74** of the retained coating on the side(s) of the traced path. Additionally, or alternatively, in some embodiments, as represented by arrow B in FIG. 2, the substrate **20** may be translated such that the liquid stream **50** from nozzle **30** traces a path on the substrate surface. In some embodiments, only one of the substrate **20** or the nozzle **30** may be translated, while in other embodiments both the substrate **20** and the nozzle **30** may be translated to trace a path using the liquid stream **50** on the substrate surface. In some embodiments, the nozzle **30** and the substrate **20** may be translated in the same direction, while in other embodiments the nozzle **30** and the substrate **20** may be translated in opposite directions. As illustrated in FIG. 1, apparatus **100** may also include an outlet conduit **80** configured to remove the liquid chemical

composition (and coating debris) after impinging on the substrate **20**. In some embodiments, suction may be provided through conduit **80** to effectively drain the residual liquid along with the debris. Although a single outlet conduit **80** is illustrated, this is only exemplary. In some embodiments, multiple conduits **80** may be provided to effectively remove the residual liquid and debris.

[0035] In some applications, the residence (or contact) time of the liquid chemical composition (e.g., the liquid stream **50**) with the coating may affect the quality of the coating removal. Residence time may be varied by controlling the speed at which the nozzle **30** and/or the substrate **20** translates to trace a path of the liquid stream **50** on the substrate surface. For example, with reference to FIG. **6**, increasing the time that the liquid stream **50** takes to trace a path across the substrate, as illustrated using curve (a), increases the residence time of the liquid stream **50** with the coating. Similarly, decreasing the time to trace the path, as illustrated using curve (b), decreases the residence time. Residence time may also be increased by tracing a path across the substrate **20** in a stepped manner as illustrated using curve (c). It is also contemplated that, in some embodiments, the liquid stream **50** may trace a same path across the substrate surface multiple times (e.g., traverse back and forth) to adequately remove the coating in the path.

[0036] It should be noted that although a single nozzle **30** of apparatus **100** is described, this is not a limitation. In some embodiments, as illustrated for example in FIG. **9A**, apparatus **100** may include multiple nozzles **30**. Each of these multiple nozzles **30** may operate in a similar manner as described above. In some embodiments, one or more nozzles **30** may be arranged at different locations of the substrate (e.g., at opposite side, edges, etc.) to simultaneously remove coating from multiple regions of a coated substrate.

[0037] FIG. **7** is a flow chart that illustrates an exemplary method **200** of removing a coating from the edge of a substrate surface using apparatus **100**. With reference to FIGS. **1-4**, apparatus **100** is positioned such that nozzle **30** is disposed at a distance (d) from the top surface of a coated substrate **20** and its longitudinal axis **90** makes an angle (θ) with the top surface of the substrate **20**. A liquid chemical composition is passed through the inner conduit **32** of the nozzle **30** to direct a liquid stream **50** at the substrate **20** through orifice **34** (step **110**). A gas is directed through the outer conduit **42** of the nozzle **30** to flow out through annular opening **44** and form a gas flow **60** that surrounds the liquid stream **50** (step **120**). The nozzle **30** and/or the substrate **20** is translated such that the liquid stream **50** with its surrounding gas flow **60** traces a path across the substrate surface (step **130**). As the liquid stream **50** traverses the path, it interacts with the coating and removes it. In some embodiments, one or more of the distance (d), angle (θ), pressure ($P_{sub.l}$) of the liquid directed through the inner conduit **32**, and the pressure ($P_{sub.g}$) of the gas directed through the outer conduit **42** may be varied to optimize the coating removal process. In some embodiments, substrate surface may be cleaned (e.g., using a different liquid) after step **130** (step **140**). For example, in some embodiments, after step **130**, a chemical composition (e.g., water, IPA, citric acid, etc.) may be directed on the surface of the substrate **20** through the nozzle **30** (e.g., through inner conduit **32**) to clean (e.g., remove residues of the chemical composition used in step **130**) the substrate surface. Additionally, or alternatively, in some embodiments, the substrate surface may be dried (e.g., using a hot gas (e.g., air, nitrogen, etc.) after coating removal in step **130** (step **150**). For example, in addition to or as an alternative to cleaning the substrate surface (i.e., step **140**) after coating removal (i.e., step **130**), a gas (e.g., hot air, hot nitrogen, etc.) may be directed to the substrate surface (e.g., through the outer conduit **42** of nozzle **30**) to dry the substrate surface. It should be noted that steps **140** and **150** and one of both of these steps may be omitted in some embodiments. In general, the above described steps may be performed in any order (e.g., step **120** may be performed before or simultaneously with step **110**, etc.). Moreover, the method may include additional steps not illustrated in FIG. **7**.

[0038] Although the current disclosure is described as being used to remove a coating from an edge (or the edge zone coating) of a substrate, this is only exemplary. For example, apparatus **100** may

be used to remove a single or multiple coatings (e.g., multi-layer coatings) from any region (e.g., center, side, etc.) of a coated substrate. Persons of ordinary skill in the art would recognize that the disclosed apparatus can be used for any application (e.g., to remove paint from the surface of a component, a metallic or polymeric coating from the surface of a ceramic/organic substrate or a semiconductor wafer, etc.). Furthermore, although in the description above, some features were disclosed with reference to specific embodiments, a person skilled in the art would recognize that this is only exemplary, and the features are applicable to all disclosed embodiments. Other embodiments of the apparatus, its features and components, and related methods will be apparent to those skilled in the art from consideration of the disclosure herein.

Claims

1-20. (canceled)

21. A method of removing a coating from a coated surface of a substrate, comprising: positioning a nozzle of an apparatus proximate the coated surface of the substrate such that a longitudinal axis of a distal end of the nozzle is inclined at an angle with the coated surface, wherein the distal end of the nozzle includes an orifice and an annular opening that extends around the orifice; discharging a liquid stream through the orifice to impinge on the coated surface; directing a gas through the annular opening to surround the liquid stream exiting the orifice such that gas surrounding the liquid stream focusses the liquid stream on a concentrated area of the coated surface and removes at least a portion of the coating from the coated surface.

22. The method of claim 21, further including directing liquid from the liquid stream away from the substrate after the liquid stream impinges on the coated surface.

23. The method of claim 21, wherein positioning the nozzle includes adjusting the angle.

24. The method of claim 21, wherein positioning the nozzle includes adjusting a distance of the distal end of the nozzle from the coated surface.

25. The method of claim 21, wherein discharging the liquid stream includes adjusting a pressure of the liquid stream exiting the orifice.

26. The method of claim 21, wherein directing the gas includes adjusting a pressure of the gas exiting the annular opening.

27. The method of claim 21, wherein discharging the liquid stream includes discharging a liquid chemical composition through the orifice, wherein the chemical composition is configured to etch the coating.

28. The method of claim 21, wherein directing the gas includes directing air.

29. The method of claim 21, further including moving the nozzle to trace a path using the liquid stream on the coated surface.

30. The method of claim 21, wherein discharging the liquid stream includes heating a liquid in the liquid stream prior to the discharging.

31. The method of claim 21, wherein discharging the liquid stream includes discharging a first liquid through the orifice as the liquid stream, and the method further includes discharging a second liquid through the orifice as the liquid stream.

32. The method of claim 31, wherein the second liquid includes one or more of water, IPA, and citric acid.

33. The method of claim 21, further including directing a heated gas through the nozzle to dry the coated surface after impinging the liquid stream on the coated surface.

34. The method of claim 21, wherein directing the gas includes directing the gas through the annular opening such that the liquid stream exiting the orifice impacts a first area of the coated surface smaller than a second area, wherein the second area is an area of the coated surface that would be impacted by the liquid stream if the liquid stream is directed through the orifice without directing the gas through the annular opening.

- 35.** The method of claim 21, wherein at least some of liquid droplets of the liquid stream that impinges on the coated surface have a tear drop shape, wherein the tear drop shape is a shape with one end curved and an opposite end pointed.
- 36.** The method of claim 21, wherein the coating is a metallic coating.
- 37.** The method of claim 21, wherein the portion of the coating is removed from the coated surface by at least one of etching and ablation.
- 38.** An apparatus to remove at least a portion of a coating from a coated surface of a substrate, comprising: at least one nozzle including, an orifice configured to discharge a liquid stream that impinges on the coated surface, an annular opening that extends around the orifice and configured to direct a gas surrounding the liquid stream exiting the orifice such that the liquid stream impinges on a concentrated area of the coated surface and removes at least a portion of the coating from the coated surface; and an outlet port configured to direct liquid from the liquid stream away from the substrate after the liquid stream impinges on the coated surface.
- 39.** The apparatus of claim 38, wherein the apparatus is configured to vary at least one of (i) an angle at which the liquid stream impacts the coated surface, (ii) a distance of the orifice from the coated surface, (iii) a pressure of the liquid stream discharged through the orifice, and (iv) a pressure of the gas directed through the annular opening.
- 40.** The apparatus of claim 38, wherein the apparatus is configured to heat the gas exiting through the annular opening.
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